

WILLIAM ELIAS

Senior DevOps / Platform Engineer | CI/CD Automation | Production Reliability | AI-Enabled Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps and platform engineer with 10+ years spanning infrastructure and networking, software QA, automation, production operations, and delivery engineering. Designed the standardized .NET CI/CD and release model for an approximately 60-application estate and created 56 Azure DevOps build/release definitions across 28 applications, with 27 builds verified green and deployment plans dry-run validated before release. Hands-on with Azure DevOps, Python, PowerShell, .NET, IIS, Azure Monitor, Application Insights, KQL, Key Vault, OAuth/IAM, SQL Server, GitHub Actions, Docker/Helm, and production incident and release workflows, plus practical AI-enabled engineering for grounded knowledge, troubleshooting, and agent workflows.

CORE EXPERTISE

DevOps & Release Engineering: Azure DevOps, Azure DevOps YAML, Classic Release, CI/CD, Pipeline as Code, Reusable Templates, Deployment Groups

Automation & Software Engineering: Python, PowerShell, C#, Go, SQL, .NET, ASP.NET Core

Security & Identity: Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, OAuth 2.0, IAM, Credential Remediation, PII controls, CodeQL

Observability & Reliability: Application Insights, Azure Monitor, KQL, Serilog, Structured Logging, Incident Triage, RCA

Infrastructure & Networking: IIS, Windows Server, Active Directory, SQL Server, Load Balancers, Firewalls, Docker

AI & Agentic Systems: MCP, RAG, ChromaDB, Vector Search, Embeddings, Multi-Agent Routing, LLM APIs

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Stellantis Financial Services US

Feb 2023 - Present

Production Support Engineer - DevOps & Automation | Auburn Hills, MI - Remote

- Designed the standardized .NET CI/CD and release model for an approximately 60-application estate; created 56 Azure DevOps build/release definitions across 28 applications, with 27 of 28 builds verified green and 25 deployment plans dry-run validated on the deployment agent.
- Built repository-to-server/deployment-path inventory, artifact validation, and environment-readiness guardrails that identified six latent delivery defects, including application-pool identity convergence risk, before any application was deployed.
- Lead weekly production releases, database migrations, and SLA-driven incident/service-request work through Freshservice and Jira; troubleshoot Azure Monitor, Application Insights, KQL, OAuth/IAM, database, API, configuration, and network-connectivity issues.
- Remediated exposed credentials across 100+ repositories and built secure Key Vault migration/rollback tooling with discovery, classification, integrity validation, and credential/PII safeguards.
- Co-led production/test server migration and DR work across Windows Server, IIS, Active Directory, firewall, database, application, and load-balancer layers, including a zero-downtime cutover from legacy infrastructure.
- Built internal AI-enabled knowledge and incident-triage tooling that synchronizes Jira, Confluence, and SharePoint context while enforcing credential, PII, provenance, and engineer-review controls.

HBK - Hottinger Brüel & Kjær

Jul 2020 - Feb 2023

DevOps Engineer - Python Automation | Southfield, Michigan / Remote

- Created a Python/Tkinter XML-output automation system that reduced data-processing time by 60%.
- Automated SQL output processing with Python, saving more than 40 hours per month.
- Developed database-configuration tools that streamlined customer onboarding and reduced repetitive setup across application environments.
- Built NSIS installer/uninstaller packages, maintained Git workflows and developer tooling, and provided live technical troubleshooting for customers.

Intrepid Control Systems

Mar 2020 - Apr 2020

QA Developer

- Wrote and executed Mocha test cases for internal software applications and debugged/validated APIs across software and hardware integrations.

Project Worldwide

Jan 2020 - Mar 2020

Network Engineer

- Configured Cisco and Meraki infrastructure across enterprise locations and executed multi-state network migrations with minimal operational downtime.

Ford Motor Company

Sep 2019 - Dec 2019

Network Standards Engineer

- Implemented global network standards and created scalable documentation and IP-management systems for enterprise infrastructure.

Trendset Communications Group

Sep 2015 - Jun 2019

IT Network Engineer

- Enforced network standards, maintained configuration files and documentation, and supported critical production infrastructure.

SELECTED DEVOPS & PLATFORM ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS

CI/CD & Release Engineering

- Designed the standard .NET build/release model for ~60 internal web applications across five servers with no prior consistent deployment path; created 56 Azure DevOps build/release definitions (28 build + 28 Classic Release) across 28 applications.
- Executed all 28 builds (27 verified green) with artifacts validated against each release definition; dry-run deployment-path validation passed for 25 of 28 applications on the live deployment agent. Zero applications are deployed through the new framework: builds are manual-triggered and releases require approval above DEV, pending go/no-go on the first real deployment.
- Pre-deployment validation identified six latent delivery defects before anything shipped, including application-pool identity convergence risk, missing-artifact assumptions against a destructive robocopy /MIR step, and false 'done' states from unverified builds.
- Organized 157 Azure DevOps definitions into a new folder convention (95 legacy inventoried/classified); built the repository-to-server-to-deployment-path inventory, the definition generator, reusable Python/.NET templates, and a WSL2 + Rancher Desktop container-host proof of concept behind IIS ARR.

Tech: Azure DevOps YAML, Azure DevOps Classic Release, Deployment Groups, Azure DevOps REST APIs, PowerShell, Python, IIS, MSBuild, .NET Framework, .NET 8, WSL2, Rancher Desktop, IIS ARR

Credential Hygiene & Secrets Remediation

- Built audit and Git-history remediation tooling that removed exposed credentials from 100+ repositories, including historical branches.
- Built a purpose-built .NET 8 utility for hash-only secret discovery, classification, Azure Key Vault migration, and integrity-verified rollback, backed by 62 automated tests; a measured server run scanned 2,832 files and identified 67 distinct secrets in 25 seconds.
- Self-review caught and corrected a migration-path integrity flaw before rollout, providing direct evidence of testing discipline and rollback safety.

Tech: .NET 8, C#, Spectre.Console, xUnit, Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, Python, PowerShell, Git history rewriting

Server Migration & DR Cutover

- Co-led build-out of four new production/test servers across OS configuration, IIS, Active Directory, firewall, application migration, database, and load-balancer layers, then helped coordinate a zero-downtime cutover from legacy infrastructure.

Tech: Windows Server, IIS, Active Directory, PowerShell, SQL Server, Load Balancers

Internal Web Apps & Support Portal

- Expanded a single-purpose query extractor into a modular ASP.NET Core support portal with a module framework, per-module access policies, and a permanently retained SOX audit trail.
- Added DBA approve-only deployment scripts, live-object diffing, a pre-CAB dashboard, and request tracking that feeds the existing service desk; covered by 156 automated tests.

Tech: ASP.NET Core 8, Razor Pages, C#, xUnit, SQLite, SQL Server, Serilog, Application Insights, Windows Authentication, DiffPlex, FastAPI

Observability & Telemetry

- Contributed to the Application Insights proof of concept that became the team standard, drove adoption across the legacy application estate, added structured logging where none existed, authored the team's reusable KQL library, and used usage telemetry to build an evidence-based application sunset list.

Tech: Application Insights, Azure Monitor, KQL, Serilog, .NET

Python Ops Automation & Estate Reduction

- Built PII-masked production-to-lower database copy tooling, failed-payload triage, event-driven query-to-email workflows, XML log parsing, and vendor report conversion.
- Installed and supported Python applications on IIS, built multi-string source search for decommission planning, scripted retirement of 300+ unused legacy applications, and standardized the team on uv.

Tech: Python, uv, FastAPI, SQL Server, PowerShell, IIS, Go

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE ENGINEERING

Multi-Agent Engineering Library

github.com/howlcipher/ai_knowledge_library

- Built a filesystem-based knowledge and rules library that loads one canonical rulebook, skill set, and profile context into Claude Code, Codex, and Gemini CLI alike, so agent behavior stays consistent across every terminal assistant.
- Ships 40 domain skills with hallucination guardrails, MCP integrations, and ChromaDB context pruning, packaged with Docker, Helm, and a cross-platform installer, guarded by GitHub Actions running CodeQL, Bandit SAST, and cross-platform tests.

AI Router

github.com/howlcipher/ai_router

- Built a local orchestrator that routes coding-agent tasks across Claude Code, Codex CLI, and Antigravity using task classification, provider health checks, fallback logic, circuit breakers, and cooldown handling.
- Tracks run history in SQLite with structured JSONL run artifacts and captured Git diffs, and enforces safe, Git-aware edit-mode guardrails so agent-driven changes stay reviewable.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

M.S. Cyber Defense - In Progress - Dakota State University

B.S. Information Technology - Colorado State University Global Campus

B.B.A. Business Administration - Rochester College

CCNA - previously held - Cisco Networking Academy (2014 - 2017)